Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Justice: development, types and Rawls theory

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 2 · Chapter Justice: development, types and Rawls theory

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Justice concerns what people are owed, how benefits and burdens should be distributed, and how institutions should treat individuals fairly.

1. Distributive justice concerns resources and opportunities; procedural justice concerns fair processes; corrective justice concerns remedies for wrongs; social justice addresses structural exclusion.

2. John Rawls asks what principles free and equal people would choose behind a veil of ignorance, where they do not know their future social position.

3. Rawls's first principle protects an equal scheme of basic liberties. His second principle permits inequalities only under fair equality of opportunity and when they benefit the least advantaged, subject to the priority of liberty.

4. Critiques ask whether Rawls gives sufficient weight to community, historical injustice, gender, global inequality or differences in individual needs.

Revision checklist

- Can I define the key concept in my own words?
- Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?
- Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?
- Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?